

# **Innovation Concepts for Reading Cinemas Australia**

*A Concept Proposal Exploring New Customer Experience,  
Digital Engagement, and Cinema Growth Opportunities*

**Innovation Ideas, Customer Experience Concepts & Implementation  
Opportunities**

**Prepared by**

Akash Joel David

Melbourne, VIC

Phone: +61 493785745

Email: akashjoeldavid@gmail.com

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/akash-joel-david/>

**Prepared for**

Executive Leadership Team

Reading Cinemas Australia

**Date**

June 2026

## **Concept One: MovieScene**

### **Concept Overview**

MovieScene is a social movie-planning feature that allows logged-in Reading Cinemas customers to create, join, and organise movie groups through the website.

The feature would appear as a dedicated Groups section on the Reading Cinemas website. A customer can create a group by selecting a movie they are interested in watching. Selecting the movie would be mandatory, while choosing the cinema location, date, and session time can remain optional. This allows users to start a group even if the final plan has not yet been confirmed.

The purpose of MovieScene is to make cinema-going more social and easier to organise. Instead of customers only booking tickets individually, MovieScene gives them a space to find others who are interested in the same movie, discuss plans, and attend together.

### **How It Works**

A user must be logged in with a Reading Cinemas account to create or join a MovieScene group. When creating a group, the user must select a movie that is currently showing at Reading Cinemas. They can then optionally choose a cinema location, preferred day, preferred session time, and maximum number of people allowed in the group.

Once the group is created, other logged-in users can browse available groups and join the ones they are interested in. Members of the group can discuss the movie plan, suggest dates or times, and decide which Reading Cinemas location they want to attend.

The user who creates the group becomes the group admin. The admin can manage the group, set the maximum number of members, and remove members if required. To prevent spam or overuse, each user should only be allowed to create a maximum of three active groups at the same time.

Each group would remain active while the selected movie is still showing at Reading Cinemas. Once the movie leaves cinemas, the group can automatically expire or be archived.

### **Business Value**

MovieScene adds a social layer to the Reading Cinemas experience. It gives customers a reason to return to the website beyond simply checking session times or purchasing tickets.

The feature can encourage more group attendance because customers are not only booking for themselves, but also planning with others. This could be useful for students, friend groups, new residents, community groups, fans of specific genres, and people who want to watch a movie but do not have a group ready.

For Reading Cinemas, MovieScene could support stronger customer engagement, increase group bookings, and help position the brand as a place for shared entertainment experiences. It also gives Reading insight into which movies are generating interest and social discussion before customers complete a booking.

## **Concept Two: Reelio Kiosk**

### **Concept Overview**

Reelio Kiosk is an in-cinema AI self-service kiosk that brings the Reelio assistant experience into the physical Reading Cinemas venue.

The kiosk would help customers choose movies, check session times, book tickets, ask cinema-related questions and receive support in multiple languages. It would be designed for customers who arrive at the cinema without a fixed movie choice, need help understanding available sessions, prefer self-service, or need assistance in a language other than English.

While the original Reelio concept focuses on the website and mobile app, Reelio Kiosk extends the same idea into the cinema environment. It creates a guided, interactive support point inside the venue, helping customers move from uncertainty to booking without needing to rely only on counter staff.

### **How It Works**

Reelio Kiosk would be placed inside selected Reading Cinemas locations, ideally near the entrance, ticketing area or foyer. Customers could interact with the kiosk using touch, text or voice.

A customer could ask simple questions such as:

“What movies are showing after 7pm?”

“What is good for kids today?”

“Do you have any Hindi or Punjabi movies?”

“What sessions are available in Gold Lounge?”

“Can I use a Companion Card?”

“Which movie is best for a date night?”

The kiosk could recommend suitable movies, show session times, explain cinema services and guide the customer toward booking tickets. It could also support multilingual conversations so customers can ask questions in their preferred language.

In future versions, Reelio Kiosk could support ticket purchases, food and beverage additions, rewards login, group booking enquiries, accessibility information and directions within the cinema.

### **Business Value**

Reelio Kiosk improves the in-cinema customer experience by giving customers a faster and more guided way to make decisions. It can reduce pressure on staff during busy periods, shorten queues and support customers who need extra help before booking.

The kiosk also creates value by making Reading Cinemas more accessible to customers from different language backgrounds. This is especially relevant for locations with strong multicultural audiences, such as Dandenong, Epping, Millers Junction, Melton and Burwood.

For Reading Cinemas, Reelio Kiosk can support higher booking conversion, better session discovery, increased awareness of food and beverage offers, improved accessibility support and stronger customer engagement inside the venue. It also reinforces Reading Cinemas as a modern, customer-focused cinema brand that uses digital innovation to improve the real cinema experience.

## **Concept Three: Tactile Cinema Device**

### **Concept Overview**

The Tactile Cinema Device is an accessibility-focused cinema innovation that allows customers to experience parts of a film through touch.

The concept involves a flat, tablet-like haptic device that can be placed on a customer's lap during a movie screening. The customer rests both hands on the surface of the device while it produces tactile feedback linked to the film. These touch patterns can represent movement, action intensity, sound events, environmental effects and emotional build-up.

The device would be especially useful for blind, visually impaired, deaf, hard-of-hearing and deaf-blind customers. It would not replace existing accessibility features such as captions or audio description. Instead, it would add another sensory layer to help customers experience the film in a more complete and immersive way.

## **How It Works**

Customers could request the Tactile Cinema Device during the ticket booking process or by contacting the cinema before their visit. When they arrive, they collect the device from the accessibility or customer service counter.

Once seated, the customer places the device on their lap and rests their hands on the surface. The device automatically synchronises with the film and delivers tactile feedback throughout the screening.

For example, if a character moves from left to right on screen, the vibration can move across the device in the same direction. If there is an explosion, the device can produce a short, strong pulse. If rain or wind appears in the scene, the device can create softer repeated patterns. If the film score builds during an emotional moment, the device can increase its vibration intensity.

After the movie, the customer returns the device to cinema staff so it can be cleaned, recharged and prepared for the next session.

## **Business Value**

The Tactile Cinema Device would help Reading Cinemas strengthen its position as an inclusive and customer-focused cinema brand. It creates a more accessible cinema experience for customers who may not be fully supported by traditional visual or audio-based film formats.

The concept could also differentiate Reading Cinemas from other cinema chains by showing a commitment to practical accessibility innovation. It gives customers with different sensory needs a stronger reason to choose Reading Cinemas and could support partnerships with accessibility organisations, community groups and inclusive technology providers.

For Reading Cinemas, the value is not only commercial. It also supports brand trust, social impact and customer inclusion by making cinema more meaningful for audiences who may currently experience films in a limited way.

## **Concept Four: Reading Pulse**

### **Concept Overview**

Reading Pulse is a film intelligence dashboard that helps Reading Cinemas identify which movies may be worth tracking, testing, acquiring or programming across different cinema locations.

The concept is designed to support programming and distribution decisions. Instead of relying only on broad release calendars, manual research or general market assumptions, Reading Pulse would bring movie data, audience signals, location insights and release opportunities into one decision-support platform.

The platform could track current theatrical releases, upcoming films, global movie activity, audience demand signals, ratings, box office indicators, trailer engagement, language relevance and local catchment fit. This would help Reading Cinemas understand not only which films are gaining attention, but also where those films may perform best across its cinema network.

### **How It Works**

Reading Pulse would operate as an internal dashboard for Reading Cinemas staff, programming teams or decision-makers.

The platform would show current and upcoming movies and rank them using a cinema-fit score. This score could consider factors such as popularity, ratings, genre, country of origin, language, release timing, audience buzz and local demographic relevance.

The dashboard could include sections such as Global Film Radar, Location Intelligence, Movie-to-Location Matching, Distributor Planner, Watchlist and Shortlist.

Global Film Radar would allow users to view films releasing around the world and identify titles that may have future potential in Australia. Location Intelligence would help Reading Cinemas understand which locations may be better suited to particular movie types, languages or audience segments. Movie-to-Location Matching would suggest where a film may perform best, while Distributor Planner would help categorise films into actions such as pursue now, test release, monitor or do not prioritise.

The Watchlist and Shortlist features would allow Reading Cinemas to track films over time before deciding whether to move forward with a release decision.

### **Business Value**

Reading Pulse would help Reading Cinemas make more informed programming decisions. It supports the business by turning scattered movie research into a structured decision-making process.

The platform could help Reading Cinemas identify smaller, international, multicultural or emerging films that may otherwise be missed. This is especially useful for locations with different audience profiles, such as Dandenong, Epping, Burwood, Melton, Millers Junction and other Victorian sites.

Reading Pulse could also reduce manual research time, improve confidence in film selection, support location-specific programming and help Reading Cinemas act earlier on films with strong potential.

For Reading Cinemas, the value is not just about finding popular movies. It is about matching the right movie to the right location at the right time.

## **Concept Five: The Reading Preview**

### **Concept Overview**

The Reading Preview is a monthly digital cinema guide that gives customers a clear and engaging view of what is coming up at Reading Cinemas.

The concept works like a digital cinema catalogue. At the start of each month, Reading Cinemas could release a new issue featuring movies releasing that month, coming soon highlights, special events, food and beverage offers, Reading Rewards updates, accessibility information and location-specific promotions.

Instead of customers only visiting the website when they already know what they want to book, The Reading Preview gives them a reason to browse, discover and plan ahead. It turns the Reading Cinemas website into a stronger content and discovery channel, not just a ticketing platform.

### **How It Works**

The Reading Preview would appear as a dedicated section on the Reading Cinemas website and could also be promoted through email, social media, QR codes inside cinemas and the Reading Rewards program.

Each monthly issue could include upcoming movie releases, family and school holiday picks, international film highlights, Gold Lounge recommendations, special screenings, food and beverage offers, rewards updates, accessibility information and cinema location news.

Customers could browse the issue like a digital magazine, with each movie, offer or event linking directly to session times, booking pages or cinema location pages. The issue could also be personalised by location, allowing customers to view what is most relevant to their nearest Reading Cinemas venue.

### **Business Value**

The Reading Preview gives Reading Cinemas a stronger way to communicate with customers before they reach the booking stage. It helps customers discover films earlier, understand what is happening at Reading Cinemas and plan visits across the month.

The concept can support stronger movie discovery, higher awareness of upcoming releases, better promotion of food and beverage offers, stronger Reading Rewards engagement and improved communication around accessibility and special events.

For Reading Cinemas, The Reading Preview could become a regular marketing asset that can be reused across email campaigns, social posts, website banners and in-cinema QR codes. It gives the business a monthly reason to re-engage customers and guide them toward bookings.

The value is similar to a retail catalogue, but adapted for cinema. Instead of showing weekly grocery specials, The Reading Preview shows customers what they can watch, experience and enjoy at Reading Cinemas that month.

## **Concept Six: Reading StoryCard**

### **Concept Overview**

Reading StoryCard is a personalised digital keepsake sent to customers after they complete an online movie booking with Reading Cinemas.

The concept adds a memorable post-booking experience by giving customers a downloadable digital card based on the movie they are going to watch. The card could match the theme, genre or mood of the film and include booking details such as the movie title, cinema location, date, session time and seat information.

Instead of the confirmation email only being functional, Reading StoryCard turns the booking moment into something more personal and shareable. It gives customers a small digital memory linked to their cinema visit, similar to a personalised event pass, movie poster or digital scrapbook card.

### **How It Works**

After a customer completes an online ticket booking, Reading Cinemas would automatically generate a personalised digital story card and include it in the confirmation email.

The card could be styled according to the movie's theme. For example, a family animation could have a bright and playful design, a horror film could use a darker cinematic style, a romance film could feel softer and warmer, and an action film could use a bold, high-energy layout.

The card could include the customer's name, movie title, cinema location, session time, seat details and a short message such as "Your movie night is set" or "See you at the big screen."



Customers could download the card, save it to their phone, add it to their calendar, or share it with friends and family. Future versions could allow customers to choose from different card styles, create group cards for multiple tickets, or receive a post-movie memory card after the screening.

## **Business Value**

Reading StoryCard improves the customer experience after booking by making the confirmation process feel more personal, polished and memorable.

For Reading Cinemas, the concept creates a stronger emotional connection with customers and gives them a reason to engage with the brand beyond the transaction. It can also encourage social sharing, especially when customers book for major releases, family outings, date nights, group events or special occasions.

The feature could support repeat engagement by including subtle prompts such as food and beverage offers, Reading Rewards reminders, upcoming movie suggestions or links to The Reading Preview.

Overall, Reading StoryCard turns a standard booking confirmation into a branded digital keepsake that customers can save, share and remember.

## **Concept Seven: Reading PosterScan**

### **Concept Overview**

Reading PosterScan is a QR-based movie discovery feature that allows customers to scan cinema posters and instantly access more information about the movie.

Inside Reading Cinemas locations, posters are already used to promote current and upcoming films. Reading PosterScan adds a digital layer to those posters by placing a QR code below each movie poster. When customers scan the code, they are taken to a mobile-friendly movie page with key information, trailers, session times and booking options for that specific film.

The concept helps customers move from casual interest to action. Instead of seeing a poster and needing to search for the movie manually, customers can scan it and immediately find out what the movie is about, when it is showing and how to book.

### **How It Works**

Each movie poster displayed inside the cinema would include a small QR code with a clear call-to-action such as “Scan for sessions”, “Watch trailer”, or “Find out more”.

When a customer scans the QR code using their phone, it opens a dedicated Reading Cinemas movie page. This page could include the movie synopsis, trailer, genre,

classification, runtime, cast, release date, available session times, cinema location, Gold Lounge availability and booking button.

For upcoming films, the page could show “coming soon” information, allow customers to add the movie to a watchlist, sign up for release alerts or view similar films currently showing.

The QR code could also be location-aware. For example, if a customer scans a poster at Reading Cinemas Epping, the page could first show session times for Epping before allowing them to change location.

## **Business Value**

Reading PosterScan turns cinema posters into interactive booking points. It helps customers act on interest immediately, which can support stronger movie discovery and increase the chance of conversion.

The concept is low-cost compared to larger digital products because it uses existing poster spaces and simple QR technology. It can also reduce customer friction by removing the need to manually search for a movie on the website.

For Reading Cinemas, PosterScan creates a bridge between in-cinema marketing and online booking. It can promote current films, build awareness for upcoming releases, support session discovery and capture customer interest before they leave the venue.

Overall, Reading PosterScan makes posters more useful by connecting them directly to information, session times and bookings.

## **Concept Eight: Audience Pulse**

### **Concept Overview**

Audience Pulse is an in-cinema QR voting feature that allows customers to show interest in upcoming movies before their current movie starts.

The concept would use a QR code shown on-screen before the film, on digital signage, or near cinema entrances. Customers scan the QR code and are shown a short list of upcoming movies. They can select which movies they would be interested in watching at Reading Cinemas.

This gives Reading Cinemas a simple way to collect real audience demand data directly from people already attending the cinema. Instead of only relying on external release calendars, online buzz or assumptions, Reading Cinemas can ask its own customers what they want to watch next.

## **How It Works**

Before the movie starts, a short on-screen message could appear saying something like “What should we bring to Reading Cinemas next? Scan and vote.”

Customers scan the QR code using their phone and are taken to a simple mobile page. The page could show a list of upcoming movies, international films, re-screening options, family titles, event screenings or smaller releases being considered.

Customers can choose one or more movies they would like to watch. The form could also ask for their preferred cinema location, preferred day or time, language preference, genre interest or whether they would attend with friends or family.

The survey should be very short so it does not interrupt the cinema experience. It could take less than one minute to complete and could close once the movie begins.

The data collected would then help Reading Cinemas understand which upcoming movies have interest across different locations. This insight could support programming, distributor conversations, test screenings, limited releases and location-specific movie decisions.

## **Business Value**

Audience Pulse gives Reading Cinemas direct customer demand data before making programming decisions.

The concept helps the business understand which movies customers are actually interested in, which locations show demand for certain films, and whether a film should be released widely, tested in selected cinemas, promoted more heavily or not prioritised.

It is especially useful for smaller films, international movies, cultural releases, re-screenings and special event programming where demand may vary by location.

For Reading Cinemas, Audience Pulse creates a low-cost feedback loop between customers and programming teams. It turns the pre-movie waiting time into a useful research moment and helps reduce the risk of choosing films without enough local demand.

Overall, Audience Pulse helps Reading Cinemas make smarter movie release decisions by listening to customers before the movie is programmed.